

*"We were together for fifteen years and I only ever called him — obviously, when I got married I had to use his proper name at our wedding, but apart from that, just nicknames."*

YL91N · lines 21-22

*"We've been together eight or nine years, so I don't think I've ever said his name. I don't know if I ever have — not even when we first met."*

LI98D · lines 720-722

*"Like my wife — I've been married thirty years — and she said to me she can probably count on one hand the number of times I actually called her by name."*

RL69N · lines 24-25

*"Because my husband — we are together for I think seventeen or eighteen years — I don't call him by his name; I hadn't all of this time."*

Z4K9L · lines 5-6

*"Even my wife — we are married nearly twenty five years — it's also a problem for me to say her name. I can say it, it's okay, but it always feels wrong."*

KR76B · lines 11-13

*"I have two children — it's not a problem with them, I call them by their names — but I usually don't call my husband by his name."*

AR88T · lines 3-5

*"This is really important, you know — I could go the completely wrong way and get completely lost, and I've got to call out his name — and I couldn't."*

HN82E · lines 57-58

*"I couldn't get his attention... standing there looking at him... I ended up just sending him a picture of himself, to say that I was here."*

ER93L · lines 138-139

*"She's walking in front of me, and I fall into a hole — and my foot gets stuck in the hole — then I would scream her name to make her stop."*

AG88N · lines 126-128

*"I might shout, but even then I'd probably shout 'your tea's ready' rather than '[name], your tea's ready'."*

LY75H · lines 937-938

*"I had to go and put myself physically in front of her and kind of go like this, because I could not make myself say [her name]."*

EE71S · lines 42-43

*"In the break I said to him, I didn't catch your name? ... That's fine — I'll probably never say it again to his face."*

EE71S · lines 209-211

*"Pet names is okay — I actually use them quite a lot, like 'hi Yuki' to her cat; but I would never say that to a human."*

RM88L · lines 806-808

*"It's harder to use my brother in law's name than it is to use a client's name."*

AA80L · lines 461-462

*"I was thinking what I can compare this to... I don't want to sound dramatic, but — saying I love you to a person for the first time."*

RI02N · lines 74-75

*"It feels like a really intimate thing, to call someone by their name — this really unpleasant, very intimate feeling."*

AR88T · lines 30-32

*"The more somebody is close to me, the harder it is to call them by their name."*

CP86N · lines 8-9

*"Using a name feels like very, very close, in a way — and avoiding the name is more safe; it's the safer option, I don't get too close."*

AR88T · lines 407-408

*"It does kind of feel intimate to use people's names, so if I don't know somebody that well it feels almost invasive."*

AN930 · lines 523-524

*"She's my closest friend but I will very rarely use her name — but when I do in conversation, I very notably feel how it's suddenly drawn us extremely close."*

AC88A · lines 577-579

*"Almost as if someone has stroked you, in a slightly creepy way; it feels too intimate and too seen and really unpleasant."*

EE71S · lines 251-252

*"In that moment that somebody shouted my name I had that real, you know — brace, brace for impact."*

EE71S · lines 241-243

*"Using names is a bit similar for me to keeping eye contact with someone."*

RM88L · lines 28-30

*"The anxiety, like the chest tightness... just like a heaviness, sometimes at the back of your head."*

AN930 · lines 79-80

*"I kind of said it before I could think, to make sure I was addressing the correct person — and I had the afterwards panic of: oh, I said it."*

ER93L · lines 156-157

*"Once I have, they just carry on, then it's a relief — isn't it stupid, it's just saying a name really."*

LI98D · lines 150-151

*"It felt like the strangest thing, and by the end of the day I was just feeling like I can't do that again."*

HN82E · lines 109-110

*"When I speak about people in the third person I don't really have issues with names... but I tend to refer to people — 'my roommate,' 'my brother' — instead of saying their names; it's less painful in the third person."*

RM88L · lines 7-14

*"People can put your whole being into one random sound, like two syllables in my case, and use that to signify me."*

AG88N · lines 251-252

*"Maybe using the name, it means like — a name is like a key to open myself."*

RA89P · line 1120

*"It feels like too much... to use other people's names — like I'm not worthy of using someone's name."*

AR97D · lines 281-283

*"I didn't necessarily think I was worthy of it or had much to offer — so why should I have a name that gets used?"*

YM84M · lines 1014-1016

*"The people I can be most myself with, and my most authentic, comfortable self, are the people I can't use names with."*

YL91N · lines 661-662

*"What a massive difference that makes — it being named and kind of recognized. It's a big thing."*

HN82E · lines 1029-1030

*"I'm not shy with my husband, but why I'm not able to say his name I don't know — it's a contradiction to me; I don't understand myself in this situation."*

Z4K9L · lines 470-471

*"I see myself as a sort of aggressive, wild personality — I think I find saying names seems aggressive."*

EN1978P · lines 447-448

*"It's because names are worth something — and because I don't see myself worthy, of some sorts, I cannot address someone else by their name."*

RA89P · lines 992-994

*"They're acknowledging that they know who I am, they're making it very personal; and yet that's the exact reason I wouldn't use somebody's name — because it's too personal."*

AS75C · lines 91-92

*"I will be nameless as long as I can be with new relationships and people, until somebody else tells them who I am."*

YM84M · lines 273-275

*"That's what you learn in counselling training — you say someone's name and it makes them feel seen, it makes them feel heard... then I can't do it where I feel the relationship status is uncertain."*

EE71S · lines 1443-1446

*"I was constantly forcing myself to do it... it kept building on itself, making it so much harder. Now that I don't force myself, when it comes up it's much easier — it is still hard, but it's easier."*

EI90AT · lines 306-313

*"Like on edge all the time, policing myself all the time."*

EI90AT · line 207

*"If I say somebody's name — what if I say it wrong, and they're gonna laugh at me, or they're gonna judge me, or they're gonna be mad."*

AA80L · lines 425-427

*"I have this feeling that she might be judging me for the way that I say her name — the way I pronounce it, or maybe the tone that I use."*

AG88N · lines 133-134

*"It feels like there's a spotlight on me."*

AC88A · lines 150-151

*"It's just what they'll think, basically — just fear of getting something wrong."*

LI98D · lines 182-183

*"It's a slight panic that I'm gonna get it wrong in that moment, that I have forgotten it somehow."*

EE71S · lines 207-208

*"Even if I know somebody's name there's always something in the back of my mind that's like: you're probably wrong, that's not their name."*

AN930 · lines 71-73

*"That fear of forcing someone to listen to me."*

LY75H · line 109

*"If I'm uncomfortable saying a name, or afraid I'll get it wrong or pronounce it wrong, I'll be less likely to engage."*

EN1978P · lines 463-464

*"I'm going to try and say your name — and I said, please don't react; act as if it's completely normal."*

HN82E · lines 107-108

*"He understood me on a proper deep level... he just got me — made me feel worthy of being understood."*

YL91N · lines 479-481 · granddad

*"My sister's just been someone who has always been there for me... and takes me for who I am."*

ER95U · lines 480-482 · sister

*"With my boyfriend... he's always there for me and supporting me no matter what I do."*

AK96G · lines 785-786 · boyfriend

*"She's very, very supportive and she supports everything I do, and she's very accepting of everything — so I also feel like I can be myself."*

RM88L · lines 701-703 · girlfriend

*"I feel very trusting, that I can feel comfortable with; where I can kind of relax, I can let my guard down."*

HS91W · lines 794-795